

【9.9| BARRON'S】As Billionaires' Ranks Swell, Here's One
Living His Best Life **亿万富豪队伍持续壮大，他却在尽情享受生活**

难度评级：★★★★☆

【考研那些事儿之经济系列】

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【 学习流程：第一遍请先看原文自己精读，第二遍对照着本精读文档进行理解。

文章标注的单词为重点单词，只提供相关注释，想要详细释义麻烦同学查一下词典哦！

另外文章底色为灰色的句子为今天的翻译作业，今日文档中的句子分析模块会提供答案，同学们请先思考再看句子分析～】

【Para.1】

How was your August? For aviation **mogul** Kenn Ricci, the answer must be fantastico, after his **epic** 70th birthday party on Italy's Lake Como. The multi-night, black-tie affair, which per Italian media featured entertainment from Mariah Carey, John Legend, Elton John, and Kenny G, was held at the Villa d'Este in Cernobbio.

- **mogul n.** /'məʊgəl/ A person who has a lot of power or money in a particular industry or activity. 大亨，巨头
The media mogul owns several television networks. 这位传媒大亨拥有数家电视网络。

- **epic adj.** /'epɪk/ Something that is impressive or ambitious in size, scope or grandeur. 宏大的，史诗级的 (本义为史诗；叙事诗)

The concert was an epic celebration of the band' s career. 这场演唱会是对该乐队生涯的史诗级致敬。

你的八月过得如何？对航空业大亨肯恩·里奇而言，答案一定是棒极了，他刚在意大利科莫湖举办了一场盛况空前的七十七岁生日派对。据意大利媒体报道，这场持续多晚、要求身着黑领结礼服的盛大活动在切尔诺比奥的埃斯特庄园酒店举行，玛丽亚·凯莉、约翰·传奇、埃尔顿·约翰、肯尼·基均登台献艺。

【Para.2】

The five-star luxury hotel, formerly a noble **residence** from the 16th century, is a “favorite and regular stop for Ricci [pronounced ‘Ricky’]... on his many visits to Lake Como for over 30 years,” notes the website of Flexjet, the company he chairs.

- **residence n.** /'rezɪdəns/ A house or other dwelling place; the fact of living in a particular place. 住所，宅邸

The ambassador' s official residence is in the capital. 大使的官邸位于首都。

由里奇担任董事长的 Flexjet 公司官网指出，这家五星级豪

华酒店原是 16 世纪的一处贵族宅邸，是里奇（发音为“瑞奇”）.....三十多年来频繁造访科莫湖时最钟爱、最常光顾的下榻之处。

【Para.3】

The party had locals wondering whether hosting an affair of this **magnitude** was too much for Lake Como. Leading up to the party, news outlet La Provencia reported that a “small army is hard at work: hundreds of professionals including artistic directors, audio/lighting technicians, set designers, drivers, makeup artists, hairstylists, and service staff. Other villas and lodging facilities have been reserved to accommodate the crew.”

- **magnitude n.** /'mægnɪtju:d/ The great size, extent or importance of something. 规模，量级（本义为巨大；重要性）

The earthquake was of unexpected magnitude. 这次地震的规模出乎意料。

这场派对的规模让当地人不禁发问：科莫湖能否承办如此规模的活动。派对筹备期间，新闻机构《拉普罗文西亚》报道称：“一大批人马正在紧锣密鼓地忙碌：数百名专业人员参与其中，包括艺术总监、音/灯光技师、舞美设计师、司机、化妆师、发型师及服务人员。另有其他别墅与住宿设施被预订，用

来安置工作人员。”

【Para.4】

It's the stuff of "Champagne wishes and caviar dreams," as Robin Leach used to say—and some light summer fare for Barron's readers. But Ricci's blowout is also **emblematic** of the flood of wealthy Americans invading Europe (**basking** in the glow of the strong U.S. dollar), and the soaring business of private aviation (no doubt, many of his guests flew on Ricci's Flexjet—a smaller, privately held competitor of Berkshire Hathaway-owned NetJets).

- **emblematic adj.** /ˌembləˈmætɪk/ Serving as a symbol of a particular quality or concept; representative. 象征性的，典型的

The incident is emblematic of the broader crisis. 这一事件是更广泛危机的缩影。

- **bask v.** /bɑːsk/ To enjoy or take great pleasure in a warm or pleasant situation. 沉浸，享受（常与 in 连用，本义为晒太阳）

She basked in the praise of her colleagues. 她沉浸在同事们的赞誉之中。

- **blowout** n. /'bləʊaʊt/ A large, lavish celebration or party; an easy victory. 盛大派对；轻松取胜（本义为爆胎；井喷）

They threw a blowout for their daughter' s graduation.
他们为女儿的毕业办了一场盛大派对。

正如罗宾·里奇昔日所言，这是一场“香槟之愿、鱼子酱之梦”的盛事，也是《巴伦周刊》读者茶余饭后的夏日谈资。但里奇这场狂欢派对同时也是两种潮流的缩影：一是美国富人涌入欧洲（享受美元走强带来的购买力红利），二是私人航空业务的蓬勃发展（毫无疑问，他的许多宾客正是乘坐里奇的Flexjet 抵达现场——Flexjet 是一家规模较小、私人所有的公司，也是伯克希尔·哈撒韦旗下 NetJets 的竞争对手）。

【Para.5】

Most significantly, though, Ricci's soiree reflects the unfettered, **inexorable** rise of the ultra rich, a point brought home in a new report, Billionaire Census 2026, by research firm Altrata. The study calculated that the number of billionaires around the globe climbed 8.2% in 2025 to 3,795, the biggest increase in five years. As for their wealth, that was up a **brisk** 12.8% to a record \$15.1 trillion, equal to 20% of the market cap of the S&P 500 index, the third consecutive year of accelerating growth.

- **inexorable adj.** /ɪnˈeksərəbl/ Continuing without any possibility of being stopped or prevented. 不可阻挡的, 坚定不移的

The inexorable march of technology reshapes every industry. 技术不可阻挡的步伐重塑着每个行业。

- **brisk adj.** /brɪsk/ Active, fast and energetic; sharp and decisive. 强劲的, 活泼的 (本义为"轻盈敏捷的")

The company reported brisk sales growth in the second quarter. 公司第二季度销售增长强劲。

- **census n.** /ˈsensəs/ An official count or survey of a population, typically recording various details. 普查, 人口调查

The national census is taken every ten years. 全国人口普查每十年进行一次。

然而更重要的是, 里奇的这场聚会折射出超级富豪阶层无拘无束、不可阻挡的崛起之势, 这也在研究机构 Altrata 最新发布的《2026 亿万富豪普查》报告中得到了印证。该报告测算, 2025 年全球亿万富豪人数攀升 8.2% 至 3,795 人, 创下五年来最大增幅。其财富总额则强劲增长 12.8% 至历史新高 15.1 万亿美元, 相当于标普 500 指数总市值的 20%, 这已是连续第三年加速增长。

【Para.6】

The main **driver**, of course, was the U.S. tech business. Ball don't lie. The number of billionaires in the U.S., home to a third of the world's "billies," grew 11.5%, to 1,265. They're worth \$6.7 trillion, or 44% of global billionaire wealth. Yes, China's billionaire population climbed 13%, but the U.S. still has three times more.

- **driver n.** /'draɪvə(r)/ A factor that causes something to happen or change. 驱动因素（熟词僻义，常见义为司机；驱动程序） 【考研大纲词汇】

Consumer spending is the main driver of economic growth. 消费支出是经济增长的主要驱动力。

主要驱动力当然是美国科技行业。数据不会说谎。美国拥有的亿万富豪数量占全球总数的三分之一，其人数增长了11.5%，达到1,265位，财富总额高达6.7万亿美元，占全球亿万富豪财富的44%。诚然，中国的亿万富豪人数也攀升了13%，但美国人数仍为中国的三倍之多。

【Para.7】

Then there's the very top of the food chain. "The planet's 29 richest people, each with fortunes above \$50 billion, had a combined net worth

of \$4.1 trillion, or a **staggering** 27% of all billionaire wealth,” Altrata notes.

- **staggering adj.** /'stægərɪŋ/ So shocking, surprising or extreme that one cannot believe it. 令人震惊的，惊人的

The project was completed at a staggering cost. 该项目以惊人的造价完工。

- **combined adj.** /kəm'baɪnd/ Formed by joining together; united; considered together as a whole. 合并的，总计的

The combined efforts of the volunteers saved lives. 志愿者们齐心协力的努力挽救了生命。

再来看看食物链最顶端。Altrata 指出：“全球最富有的 29 位富豪，个个身家超过 500 亿美元，合计净资产达 4.1 万亿美元，占全球亿万富豪财富的 27%，这一比例令人震惊。”

【Para.8】

This domain is **dominated** by U.S. tech bros. According to the Bloomberg Billionaire List, the nine richest people on the planet are all U.S. technology male centibillionaires, worth **collectively** over \$2.6 trillion.

- **dominate v.** /'dɒmɪneɪt/ To have a commanding influence or power over; to be the most important part of. 支配, 主导 【考研大纲词汇】

Large corporations dominate the global market. 大企业主导着全球市场。

- **collectively adv.** /kə'lektɪvli/ As a group; together; in a combined manner. 共同地, 集体地

The members collectively decided to postpone the meeting. 成员们集体决定推迟会议。

这一领域由美国科技圈大佬主导。根据彭博亿万富豪榜, 全球最富有的九人皆为美国科技界的男性“百亿富翁”(身价超千亿美元), 合计身家超过 2.6 万亿美元。

【Para.9】

As for **metropolises**, don't tell Zohran Mamdani, but New York is the leading city for billionaires, with that population rising 8% last year to 164. New York has more billionaires than any country other than Germany, China, and of course, the U.S. San Francisco comes in at No.3, with 99.

- **metropolis n.** /mə'trɒpəlɪs/ A very large and important city, especially the capital or chief city of a country or region. 大都市，首府 【考研大纲词汇】

Tokyo is the largest metropolis in Japan. 东京是日本最大的都市。

说到城市排名，先别告诉佐赫兰·马姆达尼，但纽约确实稳坐亿万富豪城市榜的头把交椅，其人数去年增长了 8%，达到 164 位。除德国、中国以及美国本国以外，纽约的亿万富豪数量超过世界上任何一个国家。旧金山以 99 位富豪名列第三。

【Para.10】

The No.2 and No.4 cities, Hong Kong and London, **respectively**, were the only top 15 municipalities whose billionaire population fell. One could argue both are **retreating** from globalism—in London's case, post-Brexit, and in Hong Kong's, the Chinese government's economic and societal crackdown. Singapore's billionaire population grew the most last year, perhaps at Hong Kong's expense.

- **respectively adv.** /rɪ'spektɪvli/ Used to show that items already mentioned are in the same order as the items just listed. 分别地 【考研大纲词汇】

Mary and Jane, respectively, won the first and second prizes. 玛丽和简分别获得第一和第二名。

- **retreat** v. /rɪ'tri:t/ To move away from a place or enemy; to withdraw. 撤退，退缩（熟词僻义，名词义为"静修所"） 【考研大纲词汇】

The army retreated from the battlefield under heavy fire. 部队在猛烈炮火下撤出战场。

排名第二和第四的城市：香港与伦敦，是前 15 强城市中仅有的两座亿万富豪人数下滑的城市。可以这样解释：两者都正在与全球化渐行渐远。伦敦的原因是英国脱欧后的效应，香港则是中国政府在经济与社会层面的整顿。新加坡去年亿万富豪人数增幅最大，可能正是香港富豪流失的受益者。

【Para.11】

But back to the pride of Cleveland, Ricci, who didn't make his fortune via today's **typical** wealth-creating acronyms (GPUs or AI). Ricci got super rich the old-fashioned way, he earned it (as John Houseman said in Smith Barney ads of yore), serving the super rich; specifically, selling them **fractional** shares of private jets. Flexjet doesn't release financials beyond saying it did \$4.6 billion in combined 2025 year-end revenue—up from zero when it was founded in 1995. Last year, private-

equity group L Catterton, which is backed by LVMH, led an \$800 million investment in Flexjet.

- **typical adj.** /'tɪpɪkl/ Having the distinctive qualities of a particular type of person or thing. 典型的，代表性的
【考研大纲词汇】

This is a typical example of bureaucratic inefficiency.
这是官僚主义低效的典型例子。

- **fractional adj.** /'frækʃənl/ Being a fraction or small part of a whole; not whole. 零碎的，分数的

He bought a fractional share of the racehorse. 他购入了这匹赛马的一份份额。

话题转回这位克里夫兰的骄傲——里奇。他的财富并非通过当下流行的财富代名词（如 GPU 或 AI）积累。里奇以最老派的方式成为超级富豪，他靠自己的双手赚来的（正如约翰·豪斯曼在昔日史密巴尼广告中所言），服务于超级富豪；具体而言，就是向他们出售私人飞机的“分时产权”份额。Flexjet 并未公开详细财务数据，仅披露其 2025 年合并年终营收达 46 亿美元——始于 1995 年创立之初的零起步。去年，由 LVMH 支持的私募股权集团 L Catterton 领投了一轮对 Flexjet 的 8 亿美元投资。

【Para.12】

Ricci is a Horatio Alger story on wings. Growing up in **modest** means and beginning as a pilot out of the Air Force, Ricci borrowed money, including \$500 from his dad, and bought a small **charter** business. He flew musical acts like Barbra Streisand and Elton John, and became Bill Clinton's pilot on his run for president in 1992. Ricci would later partner with Raytheon Technologies (now RTX), and then buy Flexjet from Bombardier.

- **modest adj.** /'mɒdɪst/ Not large in amount, size or value; humble and unpretentious. 不多的，谦逊的【考研大纲词汇】

She earned a modest salary but enjoyed her work. 她薪水不多，但乐在其中。

- **charter adj.** /'tʃɑ:tə(r)/ Hired or rented for private or special use, typically by a group. 包租的，特许的（名词义为宪章；特许状）

They booked a charter flight to the island. 他们预订了一班包机前往该岛。

里奇的故事是一段“插上翅膀的霍雷肖·阿尔杰式传奇”。他家境并不宽裕，从空军退役后成为飞行员。里奇四处借钱（其中包括父亲借给他的 500 美元）买下了一家小型包机公司。

他曾为芭芭拉·史翠珊和埃尔顿·约翰等音乐人执飞，并于 1992 年成为比尔·克林顿竞选总统期间的专属飞行员。里奇后来与雷神技术公司（现 RTX）合作，并从庞巴迪手中收购了 Flexjet。

【Para.13】

“We’ve chosen as a family not to **disguise** and not to hide from our wealth,” he said recently in “How Kenn Ricci Went From Pilot to Billionaire,” the first **episode** of The WSJ Money Interview. “We have family meetings every quarter, and we’re passing on wealth. I’m not waiting till I die. I want to watch my kids enjoy their wealth. We have a family limited partnership the kids can borrow from to start businesses.”

- **disguise v.** /dis'gaɪz/ To change the appearance of something so that it looks like something else; to hide one's true feelings. 伪装，掩饰（名词义为伪装物）

【考研大纲词汇】

She tried to disguise her disappointment with a smile.
她试图用微笑掩饰自己的失望。

- **episode n.** /'epɪsəʊd/ An event or a short period of time that is different from or important in a larger sequence. 一集，一段经历

The pilot episode of the series aired last night. 该剧的首播集已于昨晚播出。

“我们全家已经做出了选择，既不刻意包装财富，也不刻意隐藏财富，”他最近在《华尔街日报》金钱访谈栏目的首期节目《肯恩·里奇：从飞行员到亿万富豪》中说道。“我们每季度召开家族会议，正在把财富传给下一代。我不会等到离世才去安排。我想亲眼看着孩子们享受财富。我们设立了家族有限合伙企业，孩子们可以从中借款创业。”

August 31, 2026 | BARRON'S

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➤ **今日翻译作业**

(Para.4) But Ricci's blowout is also emblematic of the flood of wealthy Americans invading Europe (basking in the glow of the strong U.S. dollar), and the soaring business of private aviation (no doubt, many of his guests flew on Ricci's Flexjet—a smaller, privately held competitor of Berkshire Hathaway-owned NetJets).

➤ 今日句子分析

(Para.4) But Ricci' s blowout is also emblematic of the flood of wealthy Americans invading Europe (basking in the glow of the strong U.S. dollar), and the soaring business of private aviation (no doubt, many of his guests flew on Ricci' s Flexjet—a smaller, privately held competitor of Berkshire Hathaway-owned NetJets). 但里奇这场狂欢派对同时也是两种潮流的缩影：一是美国富人涌入欧洲（享受美元走强带来的购买力红利），二是私人航空业务的蓬勃发展（毫无疑问，他的许多宾客正是乘坐里奇的 Flexjet 抵达现场——Flexjet 是一家规模较小、私人所有的公司，也是伯克希尔·哈撒韦旗下 NetJets 的竞争对手）。

主句

But Ricci' s blowout is also emblematic of the flood of wealthy

转折连词 主语 (系动词) 表语

插入语 1

Americans invading Europe (basking in the glow of the strong U.S.

并列介词 of-短语 1 (现在分词短语, 修饰 wealthy Americans)

dollar), and the soaring business of private aviation

并列介词 of-短语 2

插入语 2

(no doubt, many of his guests flew on Ricci' s Flexjet)

插入状语 从句主语 从句谓语 方式状语

破折号插入语（插入语 2 内部，作 Flexjet 的同位语）

– a smaller, privately held competitor of Berkshire Hathaway-owned

定语

（核心名词）

定语（专有名词所有格）

NetJets

主句：

主语 - Ricci' s blowout（名词所有格 + 名词，作主语）；

谓语 - is also emblematic of（系动词 + 表语形容词 + 介词 of）；

表语成分（介词短语 1） - the flood of wealthy Americans invading Europe

（核心名词 flood + 介词短语 of 后置定语 + 现在分词短语 invading Europe

作 Americans 的后置定语）；

并列连词 - and（连接 emblematic of 后的两个并列宾语）；

表语成分（介词短语 2） - the soaring business of private aviation（与介词

短语 1 结构对称，the + 形容词 + 名词 + of + 名词）。

插入语 1（圆括号·现在分词短语）：

形式 - (basking in the glow of the strong U.S. dollar);

语法功能 - 作 Americans 的非限制性后置定语；

核心词 - basking（现在分词）；

介词短语 - in the glow of the strong U.S. dollar（in + 名词短语，状语）。

插入语 2 (圆括号·含完整主谓宾的小句)：

形式 - (no doubt, many of his guests flew on Ricci' s Flexjet);

语法功能 - 整段括号作介词短语 2 的非限制性后置定语，对 aviation 业务作具体例证；

插入状语 - no doubt (插入式评注状语，意为"毫无疑问")；

小句主语 - many of his guests；

小句谓语 - flew；

方式状语 - on Ricci' s Flexjet (介词短语，乘坐...)。

破折号插入语 (插入语 2 内部的同位语)：

形式 - – a smaller, privately held competitor of Berkshire Hathaway-owned NetJets –；

语法功能 - 作 Flexjet 的同位语，进一步说明这家公司；

核心词 - a smaller competitor；

复合形容词 - privately held (副词 + 过去分词，修饰 competitor)；

复合定语 - of Berkshire Hathaway-owned NetJets (专有名词所有格 + 过去分词构成的合成形容词，修饰 competitor)。

翻译技巧解析：本句较长，翻译时注意以下三点。一，主句骨架为 A is emblematic of B and C，译为"X 同时也是 B 与 C 的缩影"，简洁有力；B 与 C 结构对称，翻译时保持并列即可。二，第一个括号内为分词短语，依附于

wealthy Americans, 宜译为前置定语"享受美元走强红利而涌入欧洲的美国富人", 避免拆句造成的零散; 第二个括号内为完整小句, 可独立成句, 加分号与前文衔接, 再以"其中不少人乘坐的是..."过渡。三, 插入语 2 内部的破折号同位语描述 Flexjet, 译时可保留破折号结构。注意 competitor 前的复合修饰语 privately held (私人控股的、非上市的) 与 Berkshire Hathaway-owned (伯克希尔·哈撒韦旗下) 可以分开译为 "Flexjet 是一家规模较小、私人所有的公司, 也是伯克希尔·哈撒韦旗下 NetJets 的竞争对手" 。

➤ 写作积累

(Para.5) The study calculated that the number of billionaires around the globe **climbed 8.2% in 2025 to 3,795**, the biggest increase in five years. climbed 8.2% in 2025 to 3,795, the biggest increase in five years 在这个句子中我们可以积累数字增长型数据呈现句式：主语 + 上升动词 + 百分比 + 时间状语 + 累加终点 + 同位语（最高级 + 时间状语）。

类似的表达还有：

- ♦ rose by X% to Y, a record / a new high。例：Sales rose by 15% to \$2 billion, a record. 销售额增长 15%至 20 亿美元，创历史新高。
- ♦ soared to Y, the highest level in/on record 。例：The temperature soared to 40°C, the highest level on record. 气温飙升至 40°C，为有记录以来最高。
- ♦ jumped / surged X% year on year（同比/环比增长）。例：Online sales jumped 30% year on year. 线上销售额同比增长 30%。

语言知识补充：climb / rise / grow 强调缓慢稳健的上行；soar / surge / jump 强调急速飙升；slip / dip / drop / fall 表达下行。写作中切忌全程使用 increase 一种动词，应酌情交替使用。本句"the third consecutive year of accelerating growth"中 consecutive（连续）与 accelerating（加速）也常搭配出现，可一并记忆。

(Para.10) The No.2 and No.4 cities, Hong Kong and London,

respectively, were the only top 15 municipalities whose billionaire population fell.

respectively adv. 分别地；依次序地。置于两对并列成分之间，使前一项与后一项按序一一对应。写作中遇到并列数据、并列名词时，可用此词点出"对应关系"，避免歧义。句式：A and B, X and Y, respectively, ...（前者对应前者，后者对应后者）。

类似的表达还有：

- ♦ in that order 按相同顺序。例：The students are ranked by their scores, in that order. 学生按成绩排序，名次与分数按相同顺序对应。
- ♦ correspondingly / accordingly 相应地；据此（语义略有差异，更强调"按对应逻辑推导"）。例：Each problem and its solution are listed below, correspondingly. 每一道题及其解答按对应顺序列于下方。

语言知识补充：respectively 在句中通常置于两对并列项之后，作插入语，前后均须加逗号隔开；不可写成 respective（形容词，需作定语修饰名词，如 their respective fields 各自的研究领域）。在阅读中遇到 "X and Y, ..., respectively" 时，可直接锁定 "前对前、后对后" 的对应关系，是破解长难句的常用线索词。